

Chunlei Li (李春蕾)

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Summary

I'm a PhD candidate at the VR Lab of Beihang University from 2021, supervised by Prof. Qinpeng Zhao (赵沁平), Prof. Yang Gao (高阳), and Prof. Shuai Li (李帅). My research focuses on physical simulation in computer graphics. I was a visiting student at University College London, supervised by Prof. He Wang (王鹤). I am about to graduate in 2026/2027. Interest: Numerical Methods, Physical Simulation, Physical Based Animation, Reinforcement Learning, Computer Graphics, AI4S, PDE.

My long-term vision: bridging AI, physics, and numerics. 1) *AI for physics* (e.g. neural operators, physical foundation models): using learning to accelerate, generalize, and extend classical numerical methods. 2) *physics for AI* (e.g. learning dynamics, explanation of scaling laws, acceleration of training convergence): using PDE theory, fluid mechanics, and numerical analysis to study learning itself.

Education

University College London, Visiting PhD in Computer Science	Sept 2025 – Sept 2026
Beihang University (BUAA), PhD in Computer Science	Sept 2021 – Dec 2026
Beihang University (BUAA), MSc in Power Engineering and Engineering Thermophysics	Sept 2018 – June 2021
University of Michigan, Dearborn, Exchange Student in Energy and Power Engineering	Sept 2016 – May 2017
North China Electric Power University (Beijing), BSc in Energy and Power Engineering	Sept 2014 – July 2018

Publications

RLMuscle: Muscle-Driven Character Animation via Reinforcement Learning Under Review

Chunlei Li, Siyuan Yu, Yang Gao, Shuai Li, Peng Yu, Aimin Hao, He Wang

chunleili.github.io/project-page-rlmuscle (IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics)

Motivation: in most 3D animation pipelines artists hand-tune per-muscle activations, which is time-consuming and lacks physical realism. Novelty: an RL controller trained on a 1D Hill-type surrogate automatically discovers per-muscle activations, which then drive a GPU multigrid-XPBD volumetric simulator with Hill-type fiber constraints, animating a 194-muscle full-body model at 18 ms per frame.

MGPBD: A Multigrid Accelerated Global XPBD Solver Aug 2025

Chunlei Li, Peng Yu, Tiantian Liu, Siyuan Yu, Yuting Xiao, Shuai Li, Aimin Hao, Yang Gao, Qinpeng Zhao

10.1145/3721238.3730720 (SIGGRAPH)

Motivation: XPBD's Gauss-Seidel solver stalls on low-frequency errors, causing instability in high-resolution, high-stiffness simulations. Novelty: a global UA-AMG preconditioned CG solver with lazy prolongator reuse and lightweight near-kernel construction, greatly improving convergence and stability at low overhead.

Parallel Constraint Graph Partitioning and Coloring for Realtime Soft-Body Cutting Apr 2025

Peng Yu, Ruiqi Wang, Chunlei Li, Yuxuan Li, Xiao Zhai, Yuanbo He, Hongyu Wu, Aimin Hao

10.2312/pg.20251267 (Pacific Graphics)

Motivation: cutting changes mesh topology on the fly, invalidating the precomputed constraint partitioning and coloring that parallel GPU solvers rely on. Novelty: a parallel constraint-graph re-partitioning and re-coloring scheme that restores solver parallelism instantly, enabling realtime soft-body cutting.

A Unified Particle-Based Solver for non-Newtonian Behaviors Simulation

Dec 2023

Chunlei Li, Yang Gao, Jiayi He, Tianwei Cheng, Shuai Li, Aimin Hao

[10.1109/TVCG.2023.3341453](#) (IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics)

Motivation: non-Newtonian behaviors in blood, melting chocolate, and water-starch mixtures span fluid-like and solid-like regimes that single-purpose solvers cannot capture consistently. Novelty: a unified SPH solver using a generalized Maxwell model for unified physical modeling of viscosity, elasticity, and plasticity, reproducing shear-thinning/thickening and viscoelastic effects in one framework.

Comparison between Two Eulerian-Lagrangian Methods: CFD-DEM & MPPIC on the biomass gasification in a fluidized bed

Feb 2021

Chunlei Li, Qitai Eri

[10.1007/s13399-021-01384-2](#) (Biomass Conversion and Biorefinery)

Comparative Study of Three Modified sCO₂ Brayton Recompression Cycles Based on Energy and Exergy Analysis with GA Optimization

Jan 2021

Chunlei Li, Qitai Eri

[10.1504/IJEX.2021.115652](#) (International Journal of Exergy)

Multi-objective Optimization of sCO₂, sCO₂/tCO₂ Cycles Based on Energy-Exergy-Economy Balanced Analysis

Apr 2022

Chunlei Li, Qitai Eri

[10.1504/IJEX.2022.122308](#) (International Journal of Exergy)

Experience

R&D, Zeno Tech – Online

June 2022 – Dec 2022

- Intern: R&D of the PBD method in the DCC software using C++.

R&D, Taichi Graphics – Beijing

Feb 2023 – Sept 2023

- Intern: R&D of the PBD method. Supervised by Dr. Tiantian Liu, development of PBD solver.

R&D, Alibaba – Beijing

May 2025 – Nov 2025

- Developed a CUDA-based Houdini HDK muscle solver node using the MGPBD algorithm, achieving a 4-10x speedup over Vellum at equivalent animation quality.

Intern, miHoYo

Sept 2026 – present

- AI physics for games, focusing on neural cloth simulation.

Awards

Top 10 Outstanding Graduate Students Candidate of Beihang University: Beihang University

Outstanding Graduate of Beihang University: Beihang University

Outstanding Graduate of NCEPU (Beijing): NCEPU (Beijing)

Skills

Languages: CET Band 6: 578, CET Band 4: 560, TOEFL: 97, GRE: 323+3.5

DCC Software: Houdini(5 years user)

Physics Engines: Newton (PR contributor), MuJoCo, PhysX

World Models: Experience in debugging DreamZero